Topic 4 — Religious Movements

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Buddhism | Buddha | Buddhist Philosophy | Buddhist Councils | Buddhist Texts | Tripitaka | Cave Architecture | Hinayana | Mahayana | Vajrayana | Eightfold Path | Four Noble Truths | Ashokan Patronage | Jainism | Tirthankaras | Tirthankaras and their Symbols | Nirvana Sites of Tirthankaras | Mahavira | Parshvanatha | Five Great Vows | Digambara | Svetambara | Ajivika Sect | Shramana Tradition | Charvaka (Lokayata) | Materialist Thinkers | Heterodox Schools | Hinduism | Shaivism | Vaishnavism | Bhagavatism | Various Religious Sects

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History* I, RS Sharma, Ghatnachakra Buddhism–Jainism–Bhagavata (B–47+), UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — council order, Milinda Panha, Jain nirvana pairs, Ashokan Dhamma, Ghantasala **Last verified:** September 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A — static; no scheme/report surface for this file

Council order spines

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            The Four Buddhist Councils Chronology
                                  |
1st Council (483 BCE): Rajgriha (Sattapanni Cave)
• Patron: Ajatashatru (Haryanka Dynasty) | President: Mahakassapa
• Outcome: Compilation of Sutta Pitaka (Ananda) & Vinaya Pitaka (Upali)
                                  |
2nd Council (383 BCE): Vaishali (Balukarama Monastery)
• Patron: Kalashoka / Kakavarna (Shishunaga Dynasty) | President: Sabakami
• Outcome: First schism into Sthaviravadins (Theravada) & Mahasanghikas
                                  |
3rd Council (250 BCE): Pataliputra (Asokarama Monastery)
• Patron: Emperor Ashoka (Mauryan Empire) | President: Moggaliputta Tissa
• Outcome: Compilation of Abhidhamma Pitaka (Kathavatthu); Missionaries dispatched
                                  |
4th Council (72 CE): Kundalvana (Kashmir)
• Patron: Kanishka (Kushana Empire) | President: Vasumitra (VP: Ashvaghosha)
• Outcome: Final division into Hinayana & Mahayana; Mahavibhasha Shastra
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               The Two Jain Councils Chronology
                                  |
1st Council (c. 300 BCE): Pataliputra
• Patron: Chandragupta Maurya era | President: Sthulabhadra
• Outcome: Compilation of 12 Angas; Initial schism into Svetambara & Digambara
                                  |
2nd Council (512 CE): Vallabhi (Gujarat)
• Patron: Maitraka Kings | President: Devardhi Kshamasramana
• Outcome: Final writing of Jain Agamas (12 Angas & 12 Upangas in Ardhamagadhi)
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Books and Writers — Religious Movements

Book–writer pairs | named Buddhist and Jain works | canons stay separate

Book / text	Writer / authority	What it is for
Milinda Panha	**Menander (Milinda)** and **Nagasena**	Indo-Greek Buddhist dialogue
Buddha Charita (*Buddhacharita*) (बुद्धचरित)	**Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष)	Sanskrit Buddha-life; Kanishka age
Saundarananda (सौंदरानंद)	**Ashvaghosha**	Same court circle
Madhyamaka Karika	**Nagarjuna**	Madhyamaka / sunyata
Visuddhimagga	**Buddhaghosa**	Theravada manual
Mahavibhasha	Fourth Council circle (**Vasumitra**; Ashvaghosha age)	Sarvastivada; Kashmir / Kanishka
Tattvartha Sutra	**Umasvati**	Jain; accepted by Digambara and Svetambara
Kalpasutra	**Bhadrabahu**	Tirthankara lives; Paryushana reading
Parishishtaparvan	**Hemachandra**	Later Jain narrative

- The **Tripitaka**, **Jataka**, **Dhammapada**, and Mahayana sutras are **canon baskets**. They are not single-author match pairs like *Buddha Charita* (*Buddhacharita*).
- Jain **Angas** (अंग) are also canon heads without one personal author on the paper.
- *Milinda Panha* monk = **Nagasena**, not **Nagarjuna**.

> **Logic:** Full Tripitaka / council teaching stays in the Buddhist Texts cards below.

4.1 Buddhism

Shramana religion of the Buddha | nastika | Middle Path | no creator God

- Buddhism rose in the sixth-century BCE Ganga valley as a **shramana** reply to costly Vedic yajna and birth-varna.
- The founder is **Siddhartha Gautama**, later the Buddha.
- Refuge is taken in the **Triratna**: the Buddha, the Dhamma, and the Sangha.
- The **Madhyama Pratipad** (Middle Path) rejects palace luxury and also rejects corpse-like tapas.
- Buddhism accepts karma and rebirth, but it rejects a permanent **atman**.
- It also rejects Vedic yajna as the way out of suffering.

- The Sangha of bhikkhus and bhikkhunis later lives in viharas along trade routes.
- Missions carried the teaching to Sri Lanka, Central Asia, China, and Southeast Asia.
- In India the institutional religion faded after about the 12th century CE.

> **Logic:** Buddhism is **nastika** because it does not take the Veda as authority. Nastika here does not mean "atheist in the modern sense."

4.2 Buddha

Sakya | Kapilavastu | four great events — place is the question

Event	Place	Age / fact	Art symbol
Birth	**Lumbini** (Nepal)	Ashokan **Rummindei** pillar marks the site	**Lotus** and **bull**
Mahabhinishkramana	Kapilavastu departure	Age **29**; horse **Kanthaka**, charioteer **Channa**	**Horse**
Enlightenment	**Bodh Gaya** (Bihar)	~35; under Bodhi tree at Uruvela on Niranjana (Falgu) river after accepting milk-rice from Sujata	**Bodhi / peepal tree**
First sermon	**Sarnath / Isipatana** (UP)	Deer Park; delivered to 5 disciples (Kaundinya, Bhaddiya, Vappa, Mahanama, Assaji)	**Wheel** (often with deer)
Mahaparinirvana	**Kushinagar** (UP)	Age 80 (483 BC) at Kasia village; Malla republic; between sala trees	**Stupa**

- The Buddha was born at **Lumbini** in Nepal. Ashoka's **Rummindei** pillar confirms the birthplace and records tax relief for the village.
- His mother was **Mahamaya / Mayadevi** of the **Koliyan** clan. His father was **Suddhodana**, the Sakya chief of Kapilavastu under Kosala.
- After Mahamaya's death he was raised by foster mother **Mahapajapati Gotami**.
- Childhood name **Siddhartha**. Epithets after awakening include **Buddha** (बुद्ध), **Tathagata**, and **Shakyamuni**. **Nayaputta** is an epithet of **Mahavira**, not of Buddha.
- He married **Yashodhara** (also called Gopa / Bimba in later texts). Their son was **Rahul(a)**. Jain tradition names Mahavira's wife **Yashoda** — a separate person.
- On the night of the Great Renunciation he rode the horse **Kanthaka**. The charioteer **Channa** went with him and then turned back.
- Traditional dates are **563–483 BCE**. Some books use a shorter chronology. Either way, he is a sixth–fifth century BCE figure, not Mauryan.
- Four sights — old age, sickness, death, and an ascetic — led to **Mahabhinishkramana** at age **29**.
- He first trained under **Alara Kalama** (Samkhya-linked teacher) and **Udraka / Rudraka Ramaputra**. Extreme fasting still failed, so he took the Middle Path.

- Enlightenment came at about **35** under the Bodhi (peepal) tree at **Bodh Gaya** (Uruvela) on Vaishakha Purnima.
- **Bhumisparsha mudra** shows the earth-touching gesture that witnesses enlightenment against Mara.
- He then taught first at **Sarnath / Isipatana**, the Deer Park near Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh. The sermon is the *Dhammacakkappavattana*, the turning of the wheel of Dhamma.
- The listeners were the **Panchavargiya**, the five former companions who had left him when he gave up starvation.
- **Kaundinya** understood first. The other four were Bhadrika, Vashpa, Mahanaman, and Ashvajit.
- Early rains retreats include **Rajagriha** at **Venuvana**, a gift of Bimbisara.
- Another early rains retreat is **Vaishali** at **Kutagarasala**; the courtesan **Amrapali** gifted her mango grove there.
- Women entered the Sangha at **Vaishali** on **Ananda**'s request; first nun = **Mahapajapati Gotami**.
- **Anathapindika** gifted **Jetavana** at Shravasti (Kosala); Prasenajit / family patronage and **Pubbarama** are also remembered.
- Maximum sermons tradition clusters at **Shravasti**. He visited **Kaushambi** under **Udayana**.
- In the later Sangha, **Ananda** was the personal attendant and the reciter of the Suttas.
- **Upali** held the Vinaya because he remembered the monastic rules.
- **Sariputta** and **Moggallana** were the chief pair of disciples.
- Cousin **Devadatta** tried to split the order and seize the leadership.
- Last rains retreat memory often places him near **Vaishali** (Beluva). At **Pava**, smith **Chunda** offered **sukaramaddava**; illness followed.
- Last convert / last sermon hearer = **Subhadda** at Kushinagar.
- **Mahaparinirvana** came at age **80** at **Kushinagar** in Uttar Pradesh (Malla capital), between sala trees.
- The reclining Buddha image in the **Mahaparinirvana temple** at Kushinagar was excavated in **1876–77**.
- Relics were divided among clans. Tradition counts **eight** original relic-stupas.
- Early Buddhist art is **aniconic** (अप्रतिमेय). The Buddha is shown by a footprint, a wheel, a stupa, the Bodhi tree, or deer. There is no human statue in that phase.
- Edwin Arnold's *The Light of Asia* draws on the *Lalitavistara* and popularised "Light of Asia" for the Buddha.

> **Logic:** Birth = Lumbini. First sermon = **Sarnath**. Death = **Kushinagar**. Milinda Panha = **Nagasena**, not Nagarjuna.

4.3 Four Noble Truths

Sarnath sermon core | medical four-step

The Four Noble Truths work like a medical diagnosis: disease → cause → cure → medicine.

#	Pali name	Meaning	Key fact
1	**Dukkha**	Suffering / unsatisfactoriness	Does **not** mean “life is only pain”
2	**Samudaya**	Cause of suffering	**Tanha / trishna** (craving), fed by **avidya** (ignorance)
3	**Nirodha**	Cessation of suffering	Craving **can** stop; that stop is **nirvana**
4	**Magga**	Path to cessation	Names the **Eightfold Path** as the cure

> **Logic:** Third truth = cessation **is** possible (nirvana). Fourth truth **is** the Eightfold Path.

4.4 Eightfold Path

Ashtangika Marga | wisdom two | conduct three | concentration three

Group	Path factor	Sanskrit / Pali fact	What it means
Prajna (wisdom)	Right View	*samyag-drishti*	See the Four Noble Truths correctly
Prajna (wisdom)	Right Resolve	*samyak-sankalpa*	Right intention and renunciation
Sila (conduct)	Right Speech	*samyag-vac*	No lying, abuse, or idle harm
Sila (conduct)	Right Action	*samyak-karmanta*	Moral bodily conduct
Sila (conduct)	Right Livelihood	*samyag-ajiva*	Earn without harm
Samadhi (समाधि) (concentration)	Right Effort	*samyag-vyayama*	Train the mind and restrain unwholesome states
Samadhi (concentration)	Right Mindfulness	*samyak-smriti*	Constant awareness
Samadhi (concentration)	Right Concentration	*samyak-samadhi*	Meditative absorption

- The Eightfold Path is the **Ashtangika Marga**.
- Householders keep a floor of **panchasila**: no killing, no stealing, no sexual misconduct, no lying, and no intoxicants.
- Monks take the full **Vinaya**, not only those five precepts.
- Practising this path **is** the Middle Path in daily life.

> **Logic:** The Eightfold Path has **eight** factors. The Fourth Noble Truth **is** this path.

4.5 Buddhist Philosophy

Three marks | no soul | twelve-link chain

- Early Buddhism marks all conditioned things with three marks: **anicca** (impermanence), **dukkha**, and **anatta**.

Three marks and five skandhas

Mark / bundle	Meaning
Anicca	All conditioned things are impermanent
Dukkha	Unsatisfactoriness follows from impermanence
Anatta	There is **no permanent self** — split from Jain **jiva** and Upanishadic **atman**
Skandha	Sanskrit
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Form	**Rupa**
Feeling	**Vedana**
Perception	**Samjna**
Formations	**Samskara**
Consciousness	**Vijnana**

Dependent arising (Pratityasamutpada)

Things arise from causes, not from a creator God. The **twelve nidanas** (links) run in chain:

#	Nidana	Meaning
1	**Avidya**	Ignorance
2	**Samskara**	Volitional formations
3	**Vijnana**	Consciousness
4	**Namarupa**	Name and form
5	**Sadayatana**	Six sense bases
6	**Sparsha**	Contact
7	**Vedana**	Feeling
8	**Trishna**	Craving
9	**Upadana**	Clinging
10	**Bhava** (भाव)	Becoming

#	Nidana	Meaning
11	**Jati** (जाति)	Birth
12	**Jara-marana**	Old age and death
- Karma here is **intention**, not a god's court.		
- Nirvana is the unconditioned stop of craving, not a Jain soul flying to a siddha-loka.		
- Later Mahayana **sunyata** (emptiness) is taught by **Nagarjuna** in the *Madhyamaka Karika*.		
- **Yogacara / Vijnanavada** is linked to **Asanga** and **Vasubandhu** (वसुबंधु).		
- Buddhist logic at Nalanda is linked to Dignaga and Dharmakirti.		
- Those later labels belong with Mahayana, not with the Early Nikaya.		

> **Logic:** "Buddhism believes in atman like the Upanishads" is false. Nagarjuna is not Nagasena.

4.6 Buddhist Councils

Four north-Indian councils | place order is the first fact to hold

Councils are remembered as meetings that **fixed the teaching** after the Buddha's death.

Place order (highest-yield spine)

- The **first** council meets at **Rajagriha**.
- The **second** council meets at **Vaishali**.
- The **third** council meets at **Pataliputra**.
- The **fourth** council in the north-Indian list meets at **Kundalvana**.

#	Place	Patron / ruler	President	Main outcome
1st (~483 BCE)	**Rajagriha** (Sattapanni / Saptaparni cave)	**Ajatashatru** (अजातशत्रु) (Magadha)	**Mahakassapa**	**Upali** recited **Vinaya**; **Ananda** recited **Suttas**
2nd (~383 BCE)	**Vaishali**	**Kalashoka**	**Sabakami / Sabbakami**	Ten-point **Vinaya** dispute; split into **Sthaviravada** (elders) and **Mahasanghika** (great assembly)
3rd (**c. 250 / 247 BCE**)	**Pataliputra**	**Ashoka** (अशोक)	**Moggaliputta Tissa**	**Vibhajjavada** line wins; **Abhidhamma** and *Kathavatthu*; missions to Sri Lanka (**Mahinda**, **Sanghamitta**)

#	Place	Patron / ruler	President	Main outcome
4th (north-Indian list)	**Kundalvana**, Kashmir	**Kanishka** (कनिष्क)	**Vasumitra** (+ **Ashvaghosha** as deputy)	**Sarvastivada** school; **Sanskrit** turn; *Mahavibhasha*; Mahayana gains Kushan patronage; Buddha elevated as deity in Mahayana framing

- Theravada tradition also remembers a separate "fourth" council at **Anuradhapura** (Sri Lanka) under **Vattagamani**, when the **Pali canon was written down**.
- For the **four-council chronology** question, the fourth place is **Kundalvana** — not Anuradhapura.

> **Logic:** Order = Rajagriha (1st) → Vaishali (2nd, Sthaviravada / Mahasanghika split) → Pataliputra (3rd) → Kundalvana (4th). Anuradhapura = separate Theravada council when Pali was written down.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q105]:** Chronological order of 4 Buddhist Councils: Rajgriha (Ajatashatru) → Vaishali (Kalashoka) → Pataliputra (Ashoka) → Kundalvana (Kanishka). *(See Q1 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

4.7 Buddhist Texts

Outside the three baskets — still asked

Text	Fact
Milinda Panha	Dialogue of Indo-Greek **Menander (Milinda)** and monk **Nagasena**
Jataka	547 stories of Buddha's previous births; in Khuddaka Nikaya
Dhammapada	Verse ethics; in Khuddaka Nikaya
***Buddha Charita* (*Buddhacharita*)**	Sanskrit Buddha-life by **Ashvaghosha** (Kanishka age); also wrote *Saundarananda*
Mahavastu, ***Lalitavistara***, ***Divyavadana***	Narrative Sanskrit Buddha lives
Prajnaparamita, ***Lotus Sutra***, ***Lankavatara***	Key Mahayana sutras
Dipavamsa, ***Mahavamsa***	Sri Lankan chronicles
Visuddhimagga	Buddhaghosa's Theravada manual

- **Nagasena** answers Milinda. **Nagarjuna** wrote *Madhyamaka Karika*. **Kumarila Bhatta** is Mimamsa.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q24]:** *Milindapanho* is a philosophical dialogue in Pali between Indo-Greek King **Menander I** and Buddhist monk **Nagasena**. *(See Q3 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

4.8 Tripitaka

Three baskets | Pali Theravada canon

Pitaka	Content	Traditional reciter	Key fact
Vinaya	Monastic rules — Suttavibhanga, Khandhaka, Parivara	**Upali**	Sangha **law**
Sutta	Buddha's discourses — five nikayas (Digha, Majjhima, Samyutta, Anguttara, **Khuddaka**)	**Ananda**	**Dhammapada** and **Jataka** (547 stories) in Khuddaka
Abhidhamma	Scholastic analysis and lists	—	Tied to **Third Council** in Theravada memory; seven books include **Yamaka**, *Patthana*, *Kathavatthu*, *Puggalapannatti*, *Dhatukatha*, *Vibhanga*, *Dhammasangani*

- The Theravada canon is the **Tripitaka**, three baskets in **Pali**.
- **Triratna** of Buddhism = **Buddha**, **Dhamma** (धम्म), **Sangha** — not the Jain three jewels.
- After the rains retreat, monks hold **Pavarana**: confession of offences committed during the monsoon stay.
- Sanskrit, Chinese, and Tibetan canons are **not** this Pali trio.
- Mahayana **adds** new sutras such as the Prajnaparamita and the Lotus.
- Hold author–book pairs as separate sentences.
- The *Milinda Panha* is linked with the monk **Nagasena**.
- The *Buddha Charita* (*Buddhacharita*) and *Saundarananda* are linked with **Ashvaghosha**.
- The *Madhyamikakarika* is linked with **Nagarjuna**.
- The *Visuddhimagga* is linked with **Buddhaghosa**.
- The *Abhidharmakosha* is linked with **Vasubandhu**.

> **Logic:** Tripitaka is not one book. Abhidhamma is not Vinaya. Yamaka sits in Abhidhamma.

4.9 Hinayana

Early Buddhism | arhat ideal | Pali canon | also called Shravakayana

- **Hinayana** means "lesser vehicle." It is a **Mahayana label**, not a name the early monks chose for themselves.
- In textbooks and papers it still covers the **early Buddhist schools** that aim at **arhatship** — personal nirvana — rather than the bodhisattva vow.

- The same stream is also called **Shravakayana** (disciple vehicle), because the follower hears the teaching and wins liberation for himself.
- Here the Buddha is remembered chiefly as a **great teacher**, not as a cosmic saviour god.
- The classic canon is the **Pali Tripitaka**. Early art stays **aniconic** — wheel, stupa, footprint, Bodhi tree — not human Buddha images.
- **Hinayana is not the same word as Theravada.** Theravada is the **only surviving** Hinayana school. Sarvastivada, Mahasanghika, and the rest are extinct in India.

How the early split happened

- At the **Second Council** in **Vaishali**, monks quarrelled over **Vinaya laxity** — whether certain practices were allowed.
- The order split into **Sthaviravada** (school of elders, stricter) and **Mahasanghika** (great assembly, more liberal).
- That is the **first major schism**. It comes **before** the later Mahayana–Hinayana language.
- Commentarial tradition later counts **eighteen early schools** from these two lines. Learn the **main pairs** in the table below.

Main early schools you must know

School	Origin / link	Doctrine or practice	Region / canon
Sthaviravada	Elders' side at **Vaishali** (2nd Council)	Orthodox Vinaya; parent line of later Hinayana schools	Ancestor school — not identical with Theravada
Mahasanghika	Liberal side at **Vaishali**	More relaxed monastic rules; some branches stressed the Buddha's supramundane nature	Influenced later Mahayana thought; **not** itself Mahayana
Theravada	**Vibhajjavada** line that wins at the **3rd Council** (Ashoka)	Doctrine of analysis; arhat ideal; strict Vinaya	**Pali** Tripitaka; Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, Laos
Sarvastivada	Branched from the Sthaviravada line; dominant in the north	**Sarvam asti** — dharmas exist in past, present, and future	Kashmir, Gandhara, Central Asia; **Sanskrit**; **4th Council** at Kundalvana
Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)	Subschool of **Sarvastivada**	Defends orthodox Abhidharma through the ***Mahavibhasha***	Realist reading of "all exists"
Sautrantika	Subschool of **Sarvastivada**	Accepts **sutras** as supreme authority; rejects Vaibhashika Abhidharma orthodoxy	Sutra-only emphasis — paired trap with Vaibhashika

- **Theravada** spread to Sri Lanka through **Mahinda** and **Sanghamitta** after Ashoka's Third Council.
- **Sarvastivada** is the school tied to **Kanishka's Fourth Council** in Kashmir, where **Vasumitra** presided and the ***Mahavibhasha*** was compiled.
- **Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)** and **Sautrantika** are **Sarvastivada subschools**, not separate vehicles like Mahayana.

- **Mahasanghika** is the Vaishali split school. **Mahayana** is a later great vehicle.

> **Logic:** Hinayana does not mean bad Buddhism. It names the **arhat + early canon** path. Theravada = **only living** Hinayana school. Sarvastivada = **Sanskrit north** + 4th Council. Sthaviravada is not identical with Theravada in strict history, though papers often blur them.

4.10 Mahayana

Great vehicle | bodhisattva vow | Sanskrit sutras | Buddha as compassionate saviour

- **Mahayana** means “great vehicle.” It is the later Buddhist movement that grows from about the **1st century CE** onward in India, after the early Hinayana schools had already split.
- Where Hinayana aims at **arhatship** for oneself, Mahayana aims at the **bodhisattva** — one who seeks enlightenment but **delays final nirvana** until all beings are saved.
- The **bodhisattva vow** is the heart of this path: compassion for all sentient life, not solitary escape from samsara.
- Mahayana treats the Buddha as a **compassionate saviour** and, in later thought, as a **celestial** Buddha with many forms. He is not only a human teacher who won nirvana and disappeared.
- New scriptures are written in **Sanskrit**, not Pali. They are **added** to the older canon. Theravada still keeps the **Pali Tripitaka**.
- Buddha and bodhisattva **images** become common in art. Ajanta **Phase II** is the textbook Indian example.

How Mahayana differs from Hinayana

Point	Hinayana / early schools	Mahayana
Ideal	**Arhat** — personal liberation	**Bodhisattva** — liberation for all beings
Buddha	Great teacher	Compassionate saviour / celestial Buddha
Canon	**Pali** Tripitaka	**Sanskrit** Mahayana sutras added
Art	Early phase often **aniconic**	Human Buddha and bodhisattva images common
Living line today	**Theravada** in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia	East Asia, Nepal, Tibetan world

Mahayana sutras papers name

- The ***Prajnaparamita*** sutras teach **perfection of wisdom** and underpin much Mahayana philosophy.
- The ***Lotus Sutra*** (*Saddharmapundarika*) makes the bodhisattva path central and is closely tied to **Avalokiteshvara**.
- The ***Lankavatara*** is linked to **Yogacara / mind-only** thought.

- Narrative Sanskrit lives such as the ***Mahavastu***, ***Lalitavistara***, and ***Divyavadana*** also belong to this wider Mahayana literary world.
- Ashvaghosha's ***Buddha Charita*** (***Buddhacharita***) is a Sanskrit Buddha-life poem from the Kanishka age. It is not a Hinayana Pali text.

Spread and patronage

- Mahayana spread from India to **Central Asia**, **China**, **Korea**, **Japan**, **Vietnam**, and **Nepal**.
- **Kushan** (कुषाण) patronage — especially under **Kanishka** — helps the **Sanskrit** turn and the growth of new schools in the northwest.
- In later eastern India, **Pala** kings patronise **Nalanda** and **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला).
- **Nalanda** was founded under **Kumaragupta I** of the Gupta line. Xuanzang visited later; Palas patronised it later.

Bodhisattvas — full list

A **bodhisattva** is an enlightened being who postpones final nirvana to help others. Mahayana art and papers usually test the **five main names** below; coaching maps also list the **Eight Great Bodhisattvas** for art history.

Bodhisattva	Also called	Virtue / role	Attribute or trap
Avalokiteshvara	**Padmapani**, Lokesvara	**Compassion**; hears the cries of all beings	Lotus; central in *Lotus Sutra*; Ajanta **Padmapani** painting
Manjushri	—	**Wisdom**	Flaming sword and **Prajnaparamita** book
Vajrapani	—	**Power** / protection	**Vajra** (thunderbolt); attendant-protector of the Buddha
Maitreya	Ajita	**Future Buddha**	Only bodhisattva widely remembered in both early and Mahayana traditions
Tara	—	**Female saviour**	Compassion goddess linked to Avalokiteshvara tradition
Samantabhadra	—	Universal virtue / practice	Often paired with Manjushri in art
Kshitigarbha	—	Earth-store bodhisattva	Saves beings in hell realms
Akasagarbha	—	“Womb of space”	Space / void symbolism

- **Avalokiteshvara** is the bodhisattva of **compassion**, also called **Padmapani** when shown with a lotus.
- **Manjushri** is the bodhisattva of **wisdom**, shown with a sword that cuts ignorance and a book of **Prajnaparamita**.
- **Vajrapani** is the **power** bodhisattva who carries the **vajra** and protects the Buddha.
- **Maitreya** is the **future Buddha**, still waiting in Tusita heaven to be born after the present age.
- **Tara** is the **female saviour** bodhisattva, especially important in later Indian and Tibetan Buddhism.

- **Samantabhadra** stands for all-sided **good conduct** and is a common companion figure in Mahayana art.
- **Kshitigarbha** is remembered as the bodhisattva who cares for beings trapped in lower realms.
- **Akasagarbha** is the “space-womb” bodhisattva of the **Eight Great** set.

Mahayana philosophy schools

School	Teacher	Key text / idea	Key fact
Madhyamaka	**Nagarjuna**	*Madhyamaka Karika*; **sunyata** (emptiness)	Middle way between eternalism and nihilism
Yogacara / Vijnanavada	**Asanga** and **Vasubandhu**	Mind-only / consciousness-only	Not Early Nikaya teaching

- **Nagarjuna** founds **Madhyamaka** and teaches that all phenomena are **empty** (*sunyata*) of permanent self-nature.
- **Asanga** and **Vasubandhu** develop **Yogacara**, which analyses experience as consciousness-only.
- **Dignaga** and **Dharmakirti** later build Buddhist **logic** at **Nalanda**. They belong to the Mahayana scholastic world, not to Hinayana Vinaya memory.
- **Nagarjuna** = *Madhyamaka Karika* and **sunyata**. **Nagasena** = *Milinda Panha*.
- **Madhyamaka** and **Yogacara** are **Mahayana** philosophy schools.

> **Logic:** Mahayana = bodhisattva + Sanskrit sutras + Buddha images. Five hot names = Avalokiteshvara, Manjushri, Vajrapani, Maitreya, Tara. Madhyamaka = Nagarjuna. Yogacara = Asanga–Vasubandhu. Mahayana is **not** the Vaishali split and **not** the Buddha's own lifetime teaching.

4.11 Vajrayana

Tantric Buddhism | mantra, mandala, guru | Tibet and eastern India

- **Vajrayana** is the “diamond/thunderbolt vehicle.” It develops from **Mahayana** around the **7th–8th century CE** in eastern India.
- It uses **tantra**: mantra, mandala, mudra, initiation, and a **guru** (teacher) line.
- The religious goal remains the **bodhisattva** ideal, but the method is tantric, not sutra-only.
- **Padmasambhava** carries it to **Tibet**. Monks from **Nalanda** and **Vikramashila** also spread this stream.
- Eastern India also uses the labels **Mantrayana** and **Sahajayana** for related tantric currents.
- Vajrayana grows from **Mahayana** in the **7th–8th century CE**, after the early councils.

Three vehicles — summary

Vehicle	When	Goal	Method / canon	Living region or school
Hinayana	Early schools after Buddha	**Arhat**	**Pali** Tripitaka; strict Vinaya	**Theravada** in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia
Mahayana	From ~1st century CE	**Bodhisattva**	**Sanskrit** Mahayana sutras; philosophy schools	East Asia, Nepal, later eastern India
Vajrayana	From ~7th–8th century CE	**Bodhisattva** through tantra	Mantra, mandala, guru initiation	Tibet, Bhutan, parts of eastern India

- **Theravada** is the only Hinayana school still living. **Mahayana** and **Vajrayana** are later developments, not rival names for the same early canon.

4.12 Cave Architecture

Chaitya = hall | Vihara = monastery | Barabar is the trap

Site	Type	Meaning
Barabar–Nagarjuni (Bihar)	Earliest rock-cut caves	Mauryan polish; **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) facade; gifted to **Ajivikas**
Bhaja, Karle, Bedsa, Kondane	Western Hinayana chaityas	**Karle** (कार्ले) = largest chaitya hall
Ajanta (Maharashtra)	30 caves; famous **paintings**	Phase I = Hinayana/aniconic; Phase II = Mahayana (Padmapani)
Ellora (एलोरा)	Multi-religion hill	Buddhist 1–12, Hindu 13–29, Jain 30–34; Cave **16** Kailasa = **Shaiva**
Kanheri (कन्हेरी) (Mumbai)	Late western Buddhist	Eleven-headed Avalokiteshvara image; Sanjay Gandhi National Park
Ghantasala	Andhra stupa	**Aryaka-pillars** on platform — named site
Dhanyakataka (Dharanikota, Andhra)	Mahasanghika centre	Later Satavahana capital tradition

- A **chaitya** is a prayer hall, often with a stupa inside. A **vihara** is a monastery where monks live.
- The word **stupa** appears already in the **Rigveda** (ऋग्वेद) (pile / raised heap sense). Buddhist stupas become relic and votive monuments; the idea is **not** Buddhist-only in origin.
- **Sanchi** (सांची) is a great early stupa site but is **not** tied to a single episode of the Buddha's own life the way Lumbini, Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, and Kushinagar are.
- **Nalanda** carries a Gupta–**Kumaragupta I** foundation tradition and later Mahayana fame.
- **Vallabhi** in Gujarat holds a Hinayana memory in many notes.
- **Vikramashila** is a Pala foundation under **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल).

- **Odantapuri** (उदंतपुरी) is a Pala foundation under **Gopala**.
- **Nav Nalanda Mahavihara** is the modern Pali research centre; its foundation stone is dated **20 November 1951**.

Stupa parts (vocabulary)

Part	What it is
Anda	Hemispherical dome
Harmika	Square railing on top of the dome
Chhatra	Umbrella-like finial
Pradakshina path	Circumambulation walkway; worship is **clockwise**
Ayaka platform	Cardinal platform with **ayaka / aryaka-pillars** — southern Andhra feature

- **Sanchi** (near Vidisha) and **Bharhut** (भरहुत) (near Satna) are famous early stupas under Ashokan patronage tradition.
- **Amaravati** and **Nagarjunakonda** (नागार्जुनकोंडा) belong to the Andhra sculptural school.

> **Logic:** Amaravati school uses ayaka platforms generally, but match-the-site traps often target **Ghantasala**. Bodh Gaya is the wrong architecture family.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q80]: Ayaka platforms** and ayaka pillars are architectural signatures of Andhra Ikshvaku / Krishna Valley stupas (**Amaravati** & **Jaggayyapeta**). *(See Q4 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

4.13 Ashokan Patronage

Dhamma policy plus Buddhist missions | state ethic for all sects

What is Ashoka's Dhamma?

- After the **Kalinga war (~261 BCE)**, Ashoka turned from military conquest to **Dhamma-vijaya** (conquest through righteousness).
- His Dhamma is a **state ethic** built on **ahimsa** (non-violence), **religious tolerance**, **respect for elders**, **charity**, and **truthfulness**.
- It is **Buddhist-coloured** but **not** a conversion of the empire into a Buddhist church. He patronised **multiple sects** including Ajivikas, Brahmanas, and Jains.

Key Rock Edicts for Dhamma

Edict	What it says (key fact)
RE V	Creates **Dhamma-mahamatras — 13 years after coronation** (papers say "14th year"; treat as correct). These officers worked among **all religions**, cared for the poor, the aged, and prisoners.
RE XII	**Religious tolerance** — "One should honour others' faiths. Praising one's own and condemning others harms one's own religion."
RE XIII	**Kalinga remorse** — 1 lakh killed, 1.5 lakh deported. Ashoka's turn to Dhamma-vijaya. Names five Hellenistic kings (Antiochus II, Ptolemy II, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander of Epirus).

Rahulovada trap

- The **Bhabru / Bairat edict** lists **seven Buddhist texts** Ashoka recommended for study by monks, nuns, and laity.
- One of those seven texts is the **Laghulovada** (Rahulovada-sutta from Majjhima Nikaya) — a sermon the Buddha gave to his son Rahula about **falsehood**.
- The Rahulovada is a text Ashoka **valued**, but it is **not** the source or definition of his Dhamma. His Dhamma is his **own edict-ethic**.
- stem: "Ashoka's Dhamma is taken from the Rahulovada-sutta" → **False**.

Buddhist missions and patronage

- The **Third Buddhist Council** met at **Pataliputra** under Ashoka; **Moggaliputta Tissa** presided.
- After the council, **Mahinda** (son) and **Sanghamitta** (daughter) carried the teaching and a Bodhi-tree sapling to **Sri Lanka**.
- Tradition credits Ashoka with **84,000** stupas. Key stupas: **Sanchi** (near Vidisha) and **Bharhut** (near Satna).
- The **Sarnath lion capital** is the national emblem of India.

Multi-sect patronage

- **Barabar Hill caves** (Bihar) were donated to **Ajivikas**, not to the Buddhist sangha. This proves Ashoka patronised non-Buddhist sects.
- Rock Edict **XII** itself commands respect for **all sects** — not only his own.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q20]:** Early Jain monks wore garments; **Parshvanatha** taught 4 vows (Chaturyama); Mahavira added **Brahmacharya** (celibacy) as 5th vow and advocated nudity. *(See Q2 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

4.14 Jainism

Shramana | 24 ford-makers | ahimsa first | no creator God

Core identity

- Jainism is a **shramana** (ascetic) path. There is **no creator God**. Liberation comes through self-effort.
- There are **24 tirthankaras** ("ford-makers") in each time-cycle who rediscover and teach the path.
- Goal: free the soul from karma-matter and reach **moksha** (siddha state).

Jiva and Ajiva (soul vs non-soul)

Category	What it covers
Jiva (soul)	Every living being has a real, eternal soul. A liberated soul is called a **siddha**. This is the **opposite** of Buddhist **anatta** (no-soul).
Ajiva (non-soul)	Five types: **pudgala** (matter), **dharma** (medium of motion), **adharma** (medium of rest), **akasha** (space), **kala** (time).

Karma in Jainism

- Karma is **fine material particles** (pudgala) that physically stick to the soul — it is **not** just a moral score.
- Actions, thoughts, and passions attract karma-matter. Austerity (**tapas**) burns it off.
- Jain tapas is **stricter** than Buddhist practice. The Buddhist **Middle Path** avoids extreme austerity; Jains embrace it.

Five types of knowledge (Jnana)

#	Jnana	Meaning
1	**Mati**	Sensory knowledge (ordinary perception)
2	**Shruta**	Scriptural / verbal knowledge
3	**Avadhi**	Clairvoyance (remote perception)
4	**Manahparyaya**	Telepathy (reading others' minds)
5	**Kevala**	**Omniscience** — full, unlimited knowledge. A tirthankara attains this.

Five Kalyanakas (auspicious events of a tirthankara)

#	Kalyanaka	Event
1	**Chyavana**	Descent of the soul into the mother's womb
2	**Janma**	Birth
3	**Diksha**	Renunciation (becoming a monk)
4	**Kevala**	Attaining omniscience
5	**Nirvana**	Final liberation / death of the body

Three Jewels (Triratna) of Jainism

Jewel	Meaning
Samyak Darshana	Right faith / correct perception
Samyak Jnana	Right knowledge
Samyak Charitra	Right conduct

- This is **not** the Buddhist Triratna (Buddha–Dhamma–Sangha). traps swap the two.

Jain philosophy — Anekantavada, Syadvada, Nayavada

These are **three separate doctrines**.

Doctrine	Meaning	Key fact
Anekantavada	Reality is **many-sided** — no single statement captures the whole truth.	"Non-absolutism" or "many-sidedness of reality."
Syadvada	Seven-fold conditional predication ("*syat*" = in some respect). A way to **speak** about many-sided reality in 7 *bhangas*.	Also called **Saptabhangi**.
Nayavada	Doctrine of **standpoints** — every judgment comes from a partial viewpoint (*naya*).	Perspective-based analysis.

Saptabhangi (seven *bhangas*) — each statement is qualified by *syat* ("in some respect"):

#	Mode	Meaning
1	*Syad asti*	In some respect, it **is**
2	*Syad nasti*	In some respect, it **is not**
3	*Syad asti-nasti*	In some respect, it is **and** is not
4	*Syad avaktavya*	In some respect, it is **indescribable**
5–7	Combinations	Mix existence, non-existence, and indescribability

- Together they let Jainism accept seemingly contradictory statements without self-contradiction.
- This is **not** the Buddhist **Middle Path** (*Madhyama Pratipad*) — match-lists swap the two.

Jain emblem and symbols

- The emblem uses a **raised palm** with an **ahimsa wheel** inscribed on it.
- The Jain **swastika** marks the **four gatis** (states of rebirth: human, heavenly, animal/plant, hell). It is a religious symbol, not connected to the Nazi mark.

> **Logic:** Jainism is **nastika** (heterodox — rejects Vedic authority) but it is **not** Charvaka. It keeps soul, karma, and moksha.

4.15 Tirthankaras

24 in this avasarpini | “ford-makers”

#	Tirthankara	Key fact
1	**Rishabhanatha / Adinatha**	Born **Ayodhya** (UP); nirvana **Ashtapad**; symbol **bull**
—	**Bahubali** (son of Rishabha)	Gomateshwara at Shravanabelagola (**981 CE**); **not** one of the 24
22	**Neminatha**	Krishna’s cousin; symbol **conch**; nirvana **Girnar**
23	**Parshvanatha**	Symbol **serpent**; nirvana **Sammed Shikhar**
24	**Mahavira**	Symbol **lion**; nirvana **Pavapuri**

- There are **24** tirthankaras in this descending time-cycle. Only the last two are treated as firmly historical.
- Each has a **lanchhana** (symbol), a colour, and a yaksha–yakshi pair. Both sects use the same 24 names.
- **Mallinatha’s gender** is the split: Svetambara treats Mallinatha as a woman. Digambara treats Mallinatha as a man.

4.16 Tirthankaras and their Symbols

Lanchhana on the pedestal — match-lists use any of the 24

#	Tirthankara	Symbol
1	Rishabhanatha / Adinatha	**Bull**
2	Ajitanatha	Elephant
3	Sambhavanatha	Horse
4	Abhinandananatha	Monkey
5	Sumatinatha	Curlew / heron
6	Padmaprabha	Lotus
7	Suparshvanatha	Swastika
8	Chandraprabha	Crescent moon
9	Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha	Crocodile / makara
10	Shitalanatha	Shrivatsa
11	Shreyansanatha	Rhinoceros
12	Vasupujya	Buffalo

#	Tirthankara	Symbol
13	Vimalanatha	Boar
14	Anantanatha	Falcon / hawk (some lists: bear)
15	Dharmanatha	Vajra
16	Shantinatha	Deer
17	Kunthunatha	Goat
18	Aranatha	Fish / nandyavarta
19	Mallinatha	Kalasha
20	Munisuvrata	Tortoise
21	Naminatha	Blue lotus
22	Neminatha	**Conch**
23	Parshvanatha	**Serpent**
24	Mahavira	**Lion**

Hottest key facts: **1 bull**, **12 buffalo**, **19 kalasha**, **22 conch**, **23 serpent**, **24 lion**.

> **Logic:** Serpent = **Parshva** (23rd). Lion = **Mahavira** (24th).

4.17 Nirvana Sites of Tirthankaras

Rule: 20 at Sammed Shikhar | 4 have their own site

Only **four** tirthankaras attained nirvana outside **Sammed Shikhar / Parasnath Hill** (Giridih, Jharkhand). The other **20** — including **Parshvanatha** — attained moksha on that hill. The *Nirvana Kanda* records this pattern.

Full list — all 24 nirvana sites

#	Tirthankara	Nirvana site	State / note
1	**Rishabhanatha**	**Ashtapad** (Mount Kailash)	Separate site
2	Ajitanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
3	Sambhavanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
4	Abhinandananatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
5	Sumatinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
6	Padmaprabha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand

#	Tirthankara	Nirvana site	State / note
7	Suparshvanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
8	Chandraprabha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
9	Pushpadanta / Suvidhinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
10	Shitalanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
11	Shreyansanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
12	**Vasupujya**	**Champapuri**	Bihar (Bhagalpur belt) — **2021 UPPCS trap**
13	Vimalanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
14	Anantanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
15	Dharmanatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
16	Shantinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
17	Kunthunatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
18	Aranatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
19	Mallinatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
20	Munisuvrata	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
21	Naminatha	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand
22	**Neminatha**	**Urjayanta / Girnar**	Gujarat — separate site
23	**Parshvanatha**	Sammed Shikhar	Jharkhand (one of the 20)
24	**Mahavira**	**Pavapuri**	Bihar — separate site

High-yield facts

Tirthankara	Nirvana site
Vasupujya (#12)	**Champapuri** (Bhagalpur, Bihar)
Parshvanatha (#23)	**Sammed Shikhar** (Jharkhand)
Mahavira (#24)	**Pavapuri** (Bihar)
Neminatha (#22)	**Girnar / Urjayanta** (Gujarat)
Rishabhanatha (#1)	**Ashtapad** (Kailash)

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q131]: Neminatha** (22nd Tirthankara) symbol = **Shankha** (Conch shell); Mallinatha = Kalasha. *(See Q5 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

4.18 Parshvanatha

23rd | historical | earlier than Mahavira | Varanasi / UP link

- **Parshvanatha** is the 23rd tirthankara and is treated as historical. Tradition places him about **250 years before Mahavira**.
- Birth tradition places him at **Varanasi** in Uttar Pradesh.
- The symbol is the **serpent**. He is often shown with a snake-hood.
- Nirvana is at **Sammed Shikhar** — one of the twenty on Parasnath Hill, Jharkhand.

Fact	Parshvanatha (23rd)	Mahavira (24th)
Vows	**Four** (chaturyama): ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha	**Five** — added **brahmacharya** (ब्रह्मचर्य)
Symbol	**Serpent**	**Lion**
Nirvana	**Sammed Shikhar**	**Pavapuri**
Birth (tradition)	**Varanasi** (UP)	**Kundagrama** (Vaishali belt)

> **Logic:** Parshva is **23rd**, about **250 years before** Mahavira. Serpent = Parshva; lion = Mahavira.

4.19 Mahavira

Vardhamana | 24th | contemporary of the Buddha

- **Mahavira** (original name **Vardhamana**) is the 24th and last tirthankara — a **6th-century BCE** contemporary of the Buddha.

Timeline (traditional chronology)

When (~BCE)	Age	Event
c. 599	0	Birth at **Kundagrama** (Vaishali / Vajji belt)
c. 569	**30**	**Renunciation** — left household life (Svetambara tradition)
c. 569–557	30–42	**12 years** of tapas (austerity)
c. 557	**42**	**Kevala jnana** (omniscience) at Jrimbhikagrama
c. 557	42	**First sermon** at **Vipulachala** (Rajgir)
c. 557–527	42–72	**30 years** of preaching
c. 527	**72**	**Nirvana** at **Pavapuri** (Magadha, Bihar)

- Some books use a shorter chronology (**c. 540–468 BCE**). Either way, he belongs to the **6th–5th century BCE** — before the Mauryan empire.

Life facts

Fact	Detail
Parents	Father **Siddhartha**; mother **Trishala** (Licchavi link)
Wife (Svetambara)	**Yashoda**; daughter **Priyadarshana**
Marriage (Digambara)	Tradition says he **never married**
Chief disciple	**Indrabhuti Gautama** (of 11 ganadharas)
Symbol	**Lion**
Vows	**Five** — added **brahmacharya** to Parshva's four
Pali name	**Nigantha Nataputta**
Early companion	**Makkhali Gosala** → later Ajivika teacher
Nirvana	**Pavapuri**, Bihar

> **Logic:** Mahavira's nirvana = **Pavapuri**. Vasupujya's nirvana = **Champapuri**.

4.20 Five Great Vows

Mahavratas for monks | anuvratas for laity

- Monks keep five **mahavratas** (great vows). Householders keep milder **anuvratas** of the same five.
- **Ahimsa** (non-violence) is the **first** and foundational vow in Jain ethics.
- Mahavira's list has **five** vows. Parshva's list has **four**. **Brahmacharya** is the vow Mahavira added separately.
- **Sallekhana / santhara** is a regulated fast unto death at the end of life. It is **not** a sixth mahavrata.

#	Vow (Sanskrit)	Meaning	Monk (mahavrata)	Layperson (anuvrata)
1	**Ahimsa**	Non-violence in thought, word, and deed	Strict — no harm to any being	Avoid deliberate injury
2	**Satya**	Truthfulness	No false speech	Avoid harmful lies
3	**Asteya**	Non-stealing	No taking what is not given	No theft
4	**Brahmacharya**	Chastity / celibacy	Complete celibacy	Marital fidelity
5	**Aparigraha**	Non-possession	No property; sky-clad Digambaras take this furthest	Limit possessions

> **Logic:** Parshva taught **four** vows. Mahavira added **brahmacharya** as the fifth. Sallekhana is a regulated end-of-life fast, separate from the five vows.

4.21 Digambara

“Sky-clad”

Point	Digambara	Svetambara
Dress	**Sky-clad** (nude monks)	**White-clad**
Women’s moksha	Must be reborn as **men** (classic view)	**Women can** attain moksha
Canon	**Shatkhandagama**, **Kasayapahuda**	**12 Angas** (11 survive; **Drishtivada** lost)
Mallinatha	**Male**	**Female**
Geography	South — **Shravanabelagola**, Karnataka	North — **Vallabhi** final redaction

- **Digambara** means sky-clad. Monks are **nude**, keep no possessions (not even a bowl), and use the hands for alms.
- The **Bhadrabahu–Chandragupta** famine story takes the order south to Karnataka. **Shravanabelagola** and Gomateshwara belong to that southern story.
- Sub-sects sometimes asked: Bisapanthi, Digambara Terapanthi, and Taranpanthi.

4.22 Svetambara

“White-clad”

Jain councils and canon

After a **12-year famine** at the end of Chandragupta Maurya’s reign, **Bhadrabahu** took a southern group to Karnataka. **Sthulabhadra** stayed in Magadha and convened the first council. Digambaras reject the Pataliputra Angas. Svetambaras keep them.

Coaching often asks **two** names: Pataliputra and Vallabhi. A fuller list has a **middle pair** (Mathura + Vallabhi I) and a **final Vallabhi** writing-down.

#	Place	Leader	When (approx.)	Outcome
1st	**Pataliputra** (Bihar)	**Sthulabhadra**	~300 BCE	**12 Angas** arranged in **Ardhamagadhi**. **Drishtivada** (12th Anga) later **lost**.

#	Place	Leader	When (approx.)	Outcome
2nd (two venues at once)	**Mathura** (UP) and **Vallabhi** (Gujarat)	**Skandila** (Mathura); **Nagarjuna** (Vallabhi I)	~4th c. CE	Oral texts gathered again after famine; Mathura is the **UP** venue.
3rd (final)	**Vallabhi** (Maitraka Gujarat)	**Devardhigani Kshamashramana**	~453–512 CE	Svetambara **Agamas written down**; **11 Angas** + **Upangas**.

- **Vallabhi** = Jain Svetambara canon. **Kanishka / Kundalvana** = **4th Buddhist** council.
- **Vaishali** = **2nd Buddhist** council. Jain Vallabhi is a **different** place (Gujarat).
- The ***Tattvartha Sutra*** of **Umasvati** is accepted by **both** Digambara and Svetambara.
- **Svetambara** means white-clad. Monks and nuns wear white. A begging bowl is allowed. Images may be adorned.
- The **12 Angas** include Acharanga, Sutrakritanga, Sthananga, Samavayanga, and Bhagavati (*Vyakhyaprajnapti*). The twelfth, **Drishtivada**, is **lost**.
- The **Kalpasutra** of Bhadrabahu narrates tirthankara lives. It is recited at **Paryushana**.
- Hemachandra wrote the *Parishishtaparvan*.
- Later sub-sects: Murtipujaka, Sthanakvasi, and Svetambara Terapanthi. Yapaniya is an extinct in-between order.

> **Logic:** The split is about **clothes, canon, and women's moksha**. It is not about different 24 names.

4.23 Shramana Tradition

Renouncer stream vs Vedic yajna

- A **shramana** is a striver who wanders, lives on alms, practises tapas, and debates. The stream flowers in the **6th century BCE** against costly Vedic yajna and birth-varna.
- Schools that matter for papers are **Buddhism** (बौद्ध धर्म), **Jainism**, **Ajivika**, and **Charvaka** (चार्वाक). They share a critique of animal sacrifice and Brahmin monopoly.
- They do **not** all keep soul and karma. Charvaka dumps both.

Six rival teachers (*Samaññaphala Sutta*)

These six appear at **Bimbisara's** Magadhan court:

Teacher	Doctrine	One-line fact
Purana Kassapa	**Akriya**	Deeds have **no moral fruit**
Makkhali Gosala	**Niyati** (Ajivika)	**Fate** fixes all; effort cannot rewrite destiny
Ajita Kesakambalin	**Uccheda** materialism	Body is elements; **death is the end**

Teacher	Doctrine	One-line fact
Pakudha Kaccayana	Seven eternal elements	No real moral agency
Nigantha Nataputta	Jain path	This is **Mahavira** — ahimsa and soul
Sanjaya Belatthiputta	Scepticism	The “eel-wriggler” — refused definite answers on soul and rebirth

4.24 Ajivika Sect

Makkhali Gosala | niyati | Barabar

Fact	Detail
Founder-teacher	**Makkhali Gosala** — wandered with Mahavira, then broke away
Core doctrine	**Niyati** (fate) runs the universe; **effort cannot rewrite destiny**
Practice	Still practised **hard asceticism** despite fatalism
Patronage	**Bindusara** (बिन्दुसार) favoured Ajivikas; **Ashoka** gifted **Barabar** caves to them
Fate	Sect **dies out after the Mauryas**; known mainly from Buddhist and Jain polemics
Sites	**Barabar** caves (Ajivika) vs **Ajanta** (Buddhist paintings)

4.25 Charvaka (Lokayata)

Materialist | perception only | nastika

Fact	Charvaka position
Pramana	**Pratyaksha** (perception) is the **sole** valid means of knowledge
God / soul	**No** creator God, **no** soul, **no** afterlife
Karma / yajna	**No** karma, **no** rebirth, **no** Vedic yajna fruit
Ethics	**This-world** pleasure; “go loot” is **polemic**, not the doctrine
Founder-name	**Brihaspati** (traditional)
Sources	Original canon **lost**; recovered from opponents like Madhava’s *Sarvadarshanasangraha*
Related name	**Charaka Samhita** (चरक संहिता) = Ayurveda; **Brihaspati** = Lokayata founder-name

4.26 Materialist Thinkers

Names papers hang on Charvaka's peg

- **Brihaspati** is the sutra tradition of Lokayata.
- **Ajita Kesakambalin** is the Buddha's contemporary. Man is elements. Death is the end.
- Payasi and other "annihilationist" figures in Pali and Jain lists belong to the same Charvaka family.
- **Charaka** (चरक) the physician wrote the *Charaka Samhita* (Ayurveda) — a separate tradition from Lokayata.

4.27 Heterodox Schools

Nastika set — grouping only

School	Reject Veda?	Soul / karma?	One-line
Buddhism	Yes	No permanent soul; karma yes	Middle Path
Jainism	Yes	Soul yes; karma as matter	Ahimsa, 24 jinas
Ajivika	Yes	Fate over karma-ethic	Niyati
Charvaka	Yes	Neither	Perception-only

Orthodox **astika** six (Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Mimamsa, Vedanta) accept Veda — they are Hindu philosophy, not this nastika list.

4.28 Hinduism

Astika stream | no single founder | Vedic roots → puranic bhakti

- Hinduism has **no single founder**. It grows from **Vedic yajna → Upanishadic philosophy → epic and puranic bhakti**.
- **Shruti** (श्रुति) (heard) = Veda, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishad. **Smriti** (स्मृति) (remembered) = law codes, epics, puranas.
- The **Trimurti** frame is Brahma (creator), Vishnu (preserver), Shiva (destroyer). Brahma has a rare cult. **Devi** stands as a parallel supreme strand.
- **Bhagavatism** (Vasudeva–Krishna, Mathura) and **Shaivism** (Rudra–Shiva, linga) are the two big sectarian growth lines.

Six orthodox (astika) schools

These accept **Veda authority**. They are **not** the nastika Shramana list.

School	Focus
Nyaya (न्याय)	Logic and epistemology

School	Focus
Vaisheshika (वैशेषिक)	Atomism and categories
Samkhya (सांख्य)	Dualism: purusha and prakriti
Yoga (योग)	Discipline of mind and body (Patanjali)
Mimamsa (मीमांसा)	Vedic ritual interpretation
Vedanta (वेदांत)	Upanishadic philosophy (Advaita, Vishishtadvaita, Dvaita)

4.29 Shaivism

Shiva / Rudra | linga | Pashupata first historical sect

- Vedic **Rudra** becomes classical Shiva.
- Forms include the linga, Nataraja, and Ardhanarishvara (half Shiva–half Parvati = union of Shiva with Shakti).
- **Pashupata** is the first historical Shaiva sect. **Lakulisha** (~2nd century CE) is its named teacher. Other early names are Kalamukha and Kapalika.
- **Mattamayura** is a named Shaiva sect in Chedi inscriptions.
- **Lingayat / Virashaiva** tradition is linked to **Basava**.
- Later streams include Kashmir Shaiva and Tamil **Shaiva Siddhanta**.
- The **Nayanars** (नायनार) number **63**. Named saints are **Appar**, **Sambandar**, **Sundarar**, and **Manikkavachakar**. **Tirugyan** is a Nayanar name, not an Alvar.
- **Gomateshwara / Bahubali** at Shravanabelagola was raised under minister **Chamundaraya** (Ganga king Rachamalla IV). He is the son of the **first** tirthankara, not the last. **Mahamastakabhisheka** is the great head-anointing every twelve years.

Jyotirlinga	Place
Somnath	Gujarat
Mallikarjuna / Srisailam	Andhra Pradesh
Mahakaleshwar	Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh
Omkareshwar	Madhya Pradesh
Kedarnath	Uttarakhand
Bhimashankar	Maharashtra
Kashi Vishwanath	**Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश)
Trimbakeshwar	Maharashtra
Vaidyanath / Baidyanath	Jharkhand (Deoghar claim)
Nageshwar	Gujarat

Jyotirlinga	Place
Rameshwaram	Tamil Nadu
Grishneshwar	Maharashtra

- There are **12** Jyotirlingas in the standard list.
- Ellora Cave 16, the Kailasa, is a **Shaiva** rock temple of the Rashtrakutas. It is not a chaitya.

4.30 Vaishnavism

Vishnu the preserver | avatars | Alvars

Avatar	Note
Matsya	Fish
Kurma	Tortoise
Varaha	Boar
Narasimha	Man-lion
Vamana	Dwarf
Parashurama	Axe-Rama
Rama	Ayodhya
Krishna	Mathura
Buddha or Balarama	Lists vary
Kalki	Future

- Ritual schools include **Pancharatra**.
- **Vaikhanasa** is the other named ritual school.
- The south has **12 Alvars**.
- Their hymns are the *Divya Prabandham*.
- **Nammalvar** and the *Tiruvaymoli* are the names papers pick.
- Later four sampradayas (flag only): Sri–Ramanuja, Brahma–Madhva, Rudra–Vallabha, and Sanaka–Nimbarka.
- In Uttar Pradesh, **Ayodhya** is the Rama home.
- **Mathura** is the Krishna home. Cult origin is Bhagavatism below.
- **Tulsi / Ramcharitmanas** is later Awadhi bhakti — flag the name; full literature sits in later medieval notes.

4.31 Bhagavatism

Vasudeva–Krishna cult | Mathura (UP) | seed of Vaishnavism

- Folk hero Krishna / Vasudeva fused with Vedic Vishnu–Narayana.
- The **Heliodorus pillar** at Besnagar (Vidisha), about **113 BCE**, records a Greek ambassador from **Taxila** (तक्षशिला) who calls himself a **Bhagavata** of Vasudeva.
- This is the earliest clear stone / epigraphic evidence of Bhagavata religion in standard coaching maps.
- The **Bhagavad Gita** (भगवद्गीता) in the Mahabharata is a charter text.
- The later **Bhagavata Purana** is the other charter text.
- **Pancharatra** vyuha theology belongs to this stream.
- Gopala-Krishna of **Vrindavan / Mathura** is the Uttar Pradesh geographic home.
- Among the **12 Alvars**, **Andal** is the only woman saint usually named in prelims maps.

> **Logic:** Bhagavatism is the **early** Krishna-Vasudeva path. Vaishnavism is the wider later tent.

4.32 Various Religious Sects

Other Hindu umbrellas | one name, one sentence

- **Shaktism** worships Devi as Durga and Kali. Tradition counts **51** Shakti pithas. Named pithas include **Kamakhya**, **Vaishno Devi**, and **Vindhyachal** (विंध्याचल) in Uttar Pradesh.
- **Smartism** uses **Panchayatana** (पंचायतन): Shiva, Vishnu, Shakti, Surya, and Ganesha, in the Shankara stream.
- **Saura** (सौरा) worships Surya. Konark is the named temple. **Ganapatya** worships Ganesha. **Kaumara** worships Skanda / Murugan.
- Tantric strands cut across Shaiva and Shakta. Jagannath at Puri is syncretic Vaishnava.
- Jain caves at **Udayagiri–Khandagiri** in Odisha hold the **Hathigumpha** inscription of **Kharavela** (खारवेल). The king-question belongs to the post-Mauryan file. The cave is Jain.
- Mathura **Kankali Tila** is a Jain stupa and image site in **Uttar Pradesh**.
- Palitana, Dilwara, and Ranakpur are later Jain temple tirthas.

UP Buddhist Circuit — Teaching Card

Beyond Sarnath and Kushinagar — full UP geography

- **Sarnath** (Varanasi): **first sermon** (*Dhammacakkappavattana*) in the Deer Park; Ashokan pillar tradition.
- **Kushinagar**: **Mahaparinirvana** between sala trees; relic stupas in tradition.
- **Shravasti**: capital of **Kosala**; Buddha spent many rains retreats at **Jetavana**, gifted by Anathapindika.

- **Sankisa** (Farrukhabad, UP): tradition of the **descent from Tusita heaven** after teaching his mother.
- **Kaushambi**: monastery centre on the Yamuna; Buddha visited the city of **Udayana**.
- **Mathura**: later **Kushana** Buddhist art centre; also Jain **Kankali Tila** — separate religion fact.
- **Lumbini** (birth) is in **Nepal**, not UP — a standard geography trap.

UP Focus

Fact	Place
First sermon	**Sarnath**, Varanasi (Deer Park)
Mahaparinirvana	**Kushinagar**
Jetavana / Kosala	**Shravasti**
Descent from heaven (tradition)	**Sankisa** (Farrukhabad)
Kosambi monastery	**Kaushambi**
Parshvanatha birth tradition	**Varanasi**
Rishabhanatha birth tradition	**Ayodhya**
Jain images / stupa	Mathura **Kankali Tila**
Bhagavata / Krishna	**Mathura–Vrindavan**
Rama	**Ayodhya**
Jyotirlinga	**Kashi Vishwanath**
Shakta	Vindhyachal (Mirzapur)